THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

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CLASS 10 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL FULL-YEAR PAPER SET 1

Full Syllabus (Chapters 1–28) | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 3 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 80**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–20 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 21–26 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 27–32 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 33–38 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 31–32 and Q. 36–38.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 20 × 1 = 20

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Lencho wishes only for rain and then the hail follows. The structure mainly creates: 1

(a) suspense about the postmaster **(b)** dramatic irony
(c) a happy ending **(d)** a mystery

2. The salute of the generals in the extract can best be interpreted as: 1

(a) a request for pardon
(b) a symbol of acceptance of democracy by former opponents
(c) a sign of military pride
(d) a tradition unrelated to politics

3. The author's use of 'He could not bring himself to take the leap' is an example of: 1

(a) humour **(b)** internal conflict
(c) external conflict **(d)** description of place

4. The extract can be called a 'coming-of-age' narrative because it: 1

(a) teaches maths **(b)** lists dates
(c) describes a battle **(d)** shows a girl growing in self-awareness

5. The picture of the baker in the lesson is mostly built through: 1

(a) argument **(b)** sensory and nostalgic detail
(c) statistics **(d)** dialogue

6. Maxwell's calm in the face of chaos functions in the narrative chiefly as: 1

(a) a delay in plot
(b) a source of comic understatement and character revelation
(c) a legal defence
(d) a hint of cowardice

7. The shift in the story from joy to distress is best seen as a: 1

(a) prologue **(b)** digression **(c)** turning point **(d)** flashback

8. The Buddha's response to Kisa Gotami is best described as: 1

(a) argumentative **(b)** punitive **(c)** therapeutic **(d)** dismissive

9. The play's comedy depends on the contrast between: 1

(a) north and south **(b)** rich and poor
(c) formal purpose and petty behaviour **(d)** day and night

10. The central irony of the title lies in the fact that: 1

(a) the 'surgery' that triumphs is merely the clinic's plain care
(b) the vet was proud
(c) Tricki became a surgeon
(d) an operation succeeded

11. Which statement best describes the story's central irony? 1

(a) a rich man becomes poor
(b) a writer becomes a thief
(c) a thief is reformed by the trust of the man he planned to rob
(d) a wrestler wins

12. The principal irony of the climax is that Max: 1

(a) captures the papers
(b) wins with a lie
(c) exposes Ausable
(d) falls while trying to use an escape route that does not exist

13. The central irony of the story is best stated as: 1

(a) a professional thief is fooled by a cleverer impostor
(b) a rich man becomes poor
(c) a policeman is a thief
(d) a book is lost

14. The main irony of Griffin's situation is that: 1

(a) his greatest triumph becomes his greatest burden
(b) he is seen everywhere
(c) he is rich
(d) he is loved

15. The chapter's central argument about talent is that it: 1

(a) is purely inborn
(b) is a matter of luck
(c) depends on wealth
(d) grows through curiosity, support and effort

16. The central irony of 'The Necklace' is best described as: 1

(a) a rich woman becomes poorer
(b) a ball ends in a fight
(c) the characters suffer ten years for a worthless object
(d) a friend betrays another

17. The central irony in the title is that: 1

(a) a girl is clever from birth
(b) a girl called simple proves wise and brave
(c) a girl is rich
(d) a girl called brave is timid

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18. The central irony of the play is that: 1

(a) a leader is wise
(b) a library is destroyed
(c) a harmless children's book prevents a planned invasion
(d) a general wins a battle

19. The poem's 'turn' (volta) occurs in: 1

(a) the second stanza **(b)** the title
(c) the first line **(d)** the last word only

20. The poem's grim theme and light diction produce: 1

(a) comic relief **(b)** epic grandeur **(c)** pathos **(d)** irony of tone

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 6 × 2 = 12

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

21. How does the opening paragraph prepare readers for the disaster? 2

22. Why does Mandela present the victory as moral rather than only political? 2

23. Explain why 'His First Flight' can be called a story of self-discovery. 2

24. Why is it significant that Anne names the diary rather than leaving it as a book? 2

25. Why might the author choose a bread-seller to represent Goan culture? 2

26. Examine the ethical issue in taking a wild animal across continents. 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 6 × 3 = 18

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

27. Critically examine the statement: 'Lencho's faith is both his strength and his weakness.' 3

28. Critically comment on Mandela's idea that freedom for one requires freedom for all. 3

29. Analyse the role of setting in 'His First Flight'. 3

30. Evaluate the opening entry as a statement of purpose. 3

31. Assess the author's use of nostalgia in 'A Baker from Goa'. 3

OR

Critically assess Maxwell's decision to transport Mij, balancing affection with responsibility. 3

32. Evaluate the story as a study of a child's desire for recognition. 3

OR

Critically examine the Buddha's method of consolation. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 6 × 5 = 30

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

33. 'The real hero of the story is the postmaster, not Lencho.' Discuss. 5

34. 'Mandela's speech is a lesson in leadership.' Evaluate with reference to the extract. 5

35. 'His First Flight' is a story about fear rather than flight. Discuss. 5

36. 'Anne Frank's diary is not just a record but a companion.' Discuss with reference to the extracts. 5

OR

'Glimpses of India' offers a mosaic rather than a map of India. Discuss. 5

37. 'Mij is more than a pet; he is a teacher.' Discuss with reference to the chapter. 5

OR

'Madam Rides the Bus' is a quiet story with a loud message. Discuss. 5

38. 'The Sermon at Benares' teaches us to find peace through understanding rather than denial. Discuss. 5

OR

'The Proposal' proves that comedy can be a mirror of society. Discuss. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 80 Marks**

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